Vittorio Maria Ruffo

v.ruffo@fs.de | vittorioruffo.github.io | linkedin.com/in/vittoriomariaruffo

Education

Frankfurt School of Finance & Management *Frankfurt, Germany*

PhD in Finance and Master in Business Research and Analytics *September 2022 - present*

- Advisor: Prof. Grigory Vilkov

Collegio Carlo Alberto and University of Turin *Turin, Italy*

Second Level Specializing Master in Finance, Insurance and Risk Management *September 2021 - July 2022*

University of Verona *Verona, Italy*

Master in Banking and Finance - Quantitative Finance track *September 2019 - September 2021*

- Final Grade: 110/110 with honours
- Supervisor: Prof. Alessandro Bucciol
- Thesis in Econometrics *"Personality and investment choices: an analysis on Australian panel data"*

University of Verona *Verona, Italy*

Bachelor in Economics and Business *September 2016 - September 2019*

- Final Grade: 110/110 with honours
- Supervisor: Prof. Elena Giaretta
- Thesis in Business Management *"Tourism between sustainability and innovation: the "Glamping" phenomenon"*

Research Interests

Asset Pricing; Option-Implied Information; Decentralized Finance; News and Textual Data.

Working Papers

Cross-Market Pricing in Prediction Markets: A Comparison with Derivatives, with M. Fabi, R. Marfè, and L. Schoenleber [SSRN]

Abstract: We compare prices for 4,860 Bitcoin and Ethereum contracts on Polymarket with option-implied benchmarks from Deribit. Prices are strongly aligned, but systematic CLOB–OIP wedges remain and vary with payoff structure, contract maturity, directional demand, sentiment, announcements, volatility, and cross-market frictions. More out-of-the-money terminal claims and salient barrier states display distinctive wedge patterns, while wedges are generally larger earlier in contract life, with the clearest convergence for Reach contracts. Larger wallets allocate more notional to contracts with larger absolute wedges. A common Kou projection of Polymarket prices yields pricing distributions that broadly resemble Deribit risk-neutral distributions but place more mass outside Deribit's central return interval. A parsimonious limits-to-arbitrage framework organizes these reduced-form patterns.

Factor Dispersions, with D. Gerchik, L. Schoenleber, and G. Vilkov [SSRN]

Abstract: Dispersion strategies capture the difference in variance dynamics between a basket and its components. Even though smart-beta indices intend to load heavily on a particular factor, factor dispersions based on such baskets are exposed to risks of other factors and idiosyncratic variances. Analyzing factor dispersions through a linear factor model and equicorrelation representations, we recover driving forces behind dispersion dynamics and work out an attribution of a dispersion risk premium. As a balanced combination of systematic and idiosyncratic variance components, dispersion and its risk premium provide signals about future changes in systematic and alpha-based investment opportunities.

- Winner of the CBOE - The Options Institute - S&P Dow Jones Indices Dispersion Research Grant

Work in Progress

Firm-level News Networks, with C. Dim and G. Vilkov

Dispersion Markets and the Price of Relative News, with D. Gerchik, L. Schoenleber, and G. Vilkov

Conference and Seminar Presentations (* presented by coauthor)

2026 Decentralized Finance & Crypto Workshop at Scuola Normale Superiore (Pisa), 5th Workshop on Decentralized Finance (DeFi) in Association with Financial Cryptography 2026 (St. Kitts)*, XXVII Workshop on Quantitative Finance (Bergamo), Tech 4 Finance #3: AI and Blockchain (Paris), Designing DeFi (D^2 2026) (New York), Frontiers in DeFi 2026 (Berlin)*, 3rd Structured Retail Products and Derivatives Conference (Hagen), Future Finance Fest (3f) (Amsterdam)*, 8th Future of Financial Information Conference (Frankfurt), Research in Behavioral Finance Conference (RBFC) (Amsterdam).

2025 Second Liverpool Workshop in Option Markets (Liverpool), 14th International Moscow Finance Conference (Moscow)*, 2025 Global AI Finance Research Conference (Hong Kong), DeFi Workshop 2025 (Grenoble)*.

2024 Second Bonn-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference (Bonn), World Federation of Exchanges Research Webinar (online)*, Cboe Risk Management Conference 2024 (Snowbird)*, 2024 FMA Conference on Derivatives and Volatility (Chicago).

Teaching and Work Experience

2026	**Lecturer, Corporate Finance (Bachelor)**, Frankfurt School
2025	**TA in Portfolio Optimization in Continuous Time (Master, Prof. Francesco Sangiorgi)**, Frankfurt School
2025-2026	**Lecturer, Introduction to Economics and Finance (High school)**, Associazione Lagrange
2025-	**Lecturer, Python Bootcamp (Master), Teaching rating (4.1/5; 4.4/5)**, Frankfurt School
2024-	**TA in Financial Products & Modelling (Master, Prof. Grigory Vilkov)**, Frankfurt School
2024-	**TA in Corporate Finance (Bachelor, Prof. Larissa Schaefer and Prof. Yigitcan Karabulut)**, Frankfurt School
2024	**RA for Quantitative Asset Management, Prof. Francesco Sangiorgi**, Frankfurt School
2023	**TA in Portfolio Management (Master, Prof. Paula Cocoma)**, Frankfurt School
2022	**Teacher, Data Analysis Laboratory with R**, University of Verona
2021	**TA in Financial Econometrics (Master, Prof. Alessandro Bucciol)**, University of Verona
2021	**TA in Statistics (Bachelor, Prof. Marco Minozzo)**, University of Verona
2020-2021	**TA in Business Management (Bachelor, Prof. Elena Giaretta and Prof. Angelo Bonfanti)**, University of Verona

Scholarships and Grants

2022	**Doctoral Scholarship** Frankfurt School of Finance & Management
2021	**Merit based full tuition waiver** Collegio Carlo Alberto

Computer Skills

Python, Matlab, R, Stata, SQL, Java, Latex, Adobe Lightroom and Photoshop, Phase One Capture One

Additional Information

Languages: English (Fluent), Italian (Native speaker) | **Interests:** Photography, Hiking, Cooking